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A new era for Indian Test cricket begins on June 20, when the side starts its five-match series against England in Leeds.

For a new-look Indian batting order, now without the experience of the recently retired Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma, English conditions will present a stern examination.

Newly appointed captain Shubman Gill and his fellow batters will have their techniques tested by the moving ball in England's swing-friendly environment.

Swing has long been a defining feature of Test cricket in England. This is enabled by the country's near-perpetual overcast skies, the generally lush and unabrasive outfield, and the firm nature of its pitches.

These factors combine to ensure that swing persists throughout a Test match and is more pronounced on average than in any other SENA (South Africa, England, New Zealand, and Australia) country.

Notably, swing in England tends to remain consistent regardless of ball age. The red cherry continues to move more in the air across innings than it typically does elsewhere in the SENA group.

This phenomenon is further amplified by the use of the Dukes ball. Its pronounced seam and greater durability allow for more sustained and pronounced movement in the air.

Conversely, reverse swing is relatively rare in England. The milder weather and softer outfield reduce the chances of the ball scuffing up enough to reverse appreciably.

For Indian batters, who have grown up playing in conditions far less conducive to swing, the English

Swing test: Shubman Gill, bowled by Scott Boland at The Oval in 2023, faces another swing test as India readies for a five-match challenge in England.

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